

Code of Conduct (2025)

Document code: POL-CORP-001. Owner: Legal and Compliance (General Counsel, Hannah Brightwell), cost centre CC-5200. Approved by: the Board of Meridian Instruments Ltd. Effective date: 15 January 2025. Edition: 2025, version 4 (replaces the 2022 edition).

1. Purpose and Scope

1.1 This Code of Conduct sets out the standards of behaviour that Meridian Instruments Ltd expects from everyone who works for or on behalf of the company. It describes how our values apply in practice and where to find more detailed policies.

1.2 The Code applies to all directors, officers and employees of Meridian Instruments Ltd and its subsidiaries in the United Kingdom, the Netherlands, the United States and Malaysia, whatever their grade or location. It also applies to agency workers, contractors and consultants while they are working for us, and we expect our suppliers, distributors and agents to meet equivalent standards.

1.3 The Code cannot cover every situation. Where it does not give a clear answer, ask yourself whether the action is legal, whether it is consistent with our values, whether you would be comfortable if it were reported in the press, and whether it would be acceptable to your manager and your colleagues. If you are still unsure, ask your manager or contact compliance@meridian-instruments.example.

1.4 Where local law sets a stricter standard than this Code, the stricter standard applies. Where this Code sets a stricter standard than local law, the Code applies.

1.5 Breaches of the Code may lead to disciplinary action up to and including dismissal, in line with the Disciplinary and Grievance Procedure (POL-HR-040), and may also be breaches of law.

2. Our Values

2.1 Meridian has four values: Precision, Integrity, Care and Ownership. They were chosen by employees at all four of our sites, and they describe the company we want to be.

2.2 Precision. We make measuring instruments that people rely on to stay safe. We take the same care over our records, our reports and our promises. We do not guess where we should check, and we do not round figures to make them look better.

2.3 Integrity. We are honest with customers, colleagues, regulators and shareholders. We compete on the merits of our products and never through improper payments or misleading claims.

2.4 Care. We look after the health, safety and wellbeing of our colleagues, the people who use our products, and the communities around our sites. We treat people with respect.

2.5 Ownership. We take responsibility for our actions and their consequences. When we make a mistake, we say so and fix it. When we see a problem, we raise it.

2.6 Managers have additional responsibilities. They must lead by example, make sure their teams understand the Code, create an environment in which people feel able to raise concerns, and act promptly when concerns are raised with them.

3. Speaking Up

3.1 If you see or suspect something that breaches this Code, the law or our policies, you are expected to speak up. Early reporting allows us to deal with problems before they cause harm.

3.2 You can raise a concern with your manager, a more senior manager, People Help, Legal and Compliance, or through the confidential channels described in the Speak Up Policy (POL-CORP-004), which allow anonymous reporting where local law permits.

3.3 Meridian does not tolerate retaliation against anyone who raises a concern in good faith or who takes part in an investigation, even if the concern turns out to be unfounded. Retaliation is itself a serious breach of this Code.

3.4 Concerns will be handled confidentially and investigated fairly. Deliberately false reports made to cause harm are a disciplinary matter.

4. Respect at Work

4.1 Everyone at Meridian has the right to be treated with dignity and respect. We do not tolerate harassment, bullying, discrimination or victimisation in any form, whether in person, in writing, online or at work-related social events.

4.2 Harassment includes unwanted conduct related to a protected characteristic that violates a person's dignity or creates an intimidating, hostile, degrading, humiliating or offensive environment. Sexual harassment includes unwanted conduct of a sexual nature. Meridian takes reasonable steps to prevent sexual harassment, including training for all managers.

4.3 Decisions about recruitment, pay, promotion, development and dismissal must be based on merit and objective criteria. The Recruitment and Selection Manual (POL-HR-052) sets out how we make fair hiring decisions.

4.4 We respect the human rights of our employees and of workers in our supply chain. We do not use forced, bonded or child labour, and we expect the same of our suppliers. Our annual Modern Slavery and Human Trafficking Statement describes the steps we take.

4.5 We respect the right of employees to join, or not to join, a trade union or works council, and to take part in collective bargaining where local law provides for it. In the Netherlands we consult the works council (ondernemingsraad) on matters where it has statutory rights.

5. Health, Safety and Environment

5.1 Our products protect workers in hazardous environments, and we apply the same seriousness to safety at our own sites. Every employee must follow safety rules, use the protective equipment provided and report hazards, accidents and near misses. The Employee Handbook (HBK-HR-001) explains site-specific requirements.

5.2 You have the right to stop any work that you believe is unsafe, and you will not be penalised for doing so in good faith.

5.3 We aim to reduce the environmental impact of our operations and products, including energy use at our manufacturing sites in Leeds and Penang, packaging waste and the recovery of end-of-life instruments. Our battery take-back and calibration gas cylinder return schemes must be followed.

5.4 Product safety is fundamental. Never ship, release or certify a product that you know or suspect does not meet its specification or the relevant safety standard. Report product quality concerns to Quality Assurance immediately.

6. Conflicts of Interest

6.1 A conflict of interest arises when your personal interests, or those of a close family

member or friend, could influence, or appear to influence, your judgement in your work for Meridian.

6.2 Common examples include:

- having a financial interest in a supplier, customer, distributor or competitor;
- working for, or providing services to, another organisation that does business with or competes with Meridian;
- being involved in a decision to hire, promote, pay or manage a close relative or partner;
- using Meridian's information or opportunities for personal gain;
- sitting on the board of an organisation whose interests may conflict with Meridian's.

6.3 Having a conflict of interest is not in itself a breach of this Code. Failing to declare it is. Declarations allow us to put sensible safeguards in place, such as removing you from a particular decision.

6.4 You must declare any actual or potential conflict of interest as soon as it arises using the Conflict of Interest Declaration (F-150). In addition, all employees in grade G6 and above, and all employees in Finance, Procurement, Sales and Legal and Compliance regardless of grade, must complete an annual declaration by 30 April each year, even if they have nothing to declare. Declarations are made in Keel under Keel > Compliance > Declarations. Your manager and Legal and Compliance will review the declaration and agree any actions with you.

6.5 Shareholdings of up to 1% in a publicly listed company do not normally need to be declared unless you are directly involved in dealings with that company. Any interest in a privately owned supplier, customer or competitor must be declared.

6.6 Outside employment is permitted provided it does not conflict with your duties to Meridian, does not use company time or resources, and does not breach the Working Time Regulations or equivalent local rules. It must be declared on F-150.

7. Anti-Bribery and Corruption

7.1 Meridian has zero tolerance for bribery and corruption. We comply with the UK Bribery Act 2010, the US Foreign Corrupt Practices Act, the Dutch Criminal Code, the Malaysian Anti-Corruption Commission Act 2009 and all other applicable anti-corruption laws.

7.2 You must never offer, promise, give, request or accept a bribe, directly or through a third party. A bribe is anything of value given or received to improperly influence a decision or to obtain or keep business or an advantage. It does not have to be cash; it can include gifts, hospitality, travel, jobs or internships for relatives, donations or discounts.

7.3 Public officials require special care. Public officials include employees of government agencies, regulators, customs and port authorities, state-owned enterprises, and public utilities. Many of our customers in the water and energy sectors are state-owned, so their employees count as public officials.

7.4 We are responsible for the actions of third parties acting on our behalf, including sales agents, distributors, freight forwarders and customs brokers. All such third parties must be approved through the third-party due diligence process run by Legal and Compliance before they are appointed, and their contracts must include anti-bribery clauses. Commissions must be reasonable, paid only against documented services, and paid into an account in the third party's own name in the country where the services are performed.

7.5 Facilitation payments, meaning small unofficial payments to speed up a routine government action such as clearing goods through customs or issuing a visa, are prohibited everywhere, even where they are common practice or technically permitted by local law. The only exception

is where a payment is demanded under duress, meaning that you reasonably believe your personal safety or liberty is at immediate risk. In that case, make the payment, keep yourself safe, and report it to Legal and Compliance within 24 hours so that it can be properly recorded and followed up. Duress payments will never be treated as a disciplinary matter.

7.6 Red flags that must be reported include requests for payment in cash or to an offshore account, unusually high commissions, a third party recommended by a public official, and reluctance to agree to anti-bribery terms.

7.7 Accurate books and records are our best protection. All payments must be recorded accurately and in enough detail to show their true purpose. Never create false or misleading entries in Atlas or elsewhere.

8. Competition and Fair Dealing

8.1 We compete vigorously and fairly. Competition laws in the UK, the EU, the United States and Malaysia prohibit agreements between competitors that restrict competition, such as fixing prices, sharing markets or customers, or rigging bids.

8.2 Do not discuss prices, margins, bids, capacity or customer plans with competitors, including at trade association meetings and industry events. If such a discussion starts, object, leave the meeting and report it to Legal and Compliance.

8.3 Do not agree with distributors the prices at which they resell our products, and do not restrict their ability to sell online, without advice from Legal and Compliance.

8.4 Gather information about competitors only from legitimate public sources. Never use confidential information belonging to a competitor, even if it has been offered to you, and never ask a new employee to share confidential information from a former employer.

8.5 Make only accurate, verifiable claims about our products and those of competitors. Performance claims for Halcyon, Tessera and Lumen products must be supported by test data held by the relevant engineering team.

8.6 Trade association membership must be approved by the relevant ExCo member. Before attending a trade association meeting, check that there is a written agenda and that minutes will be taken, and keep your own notes of what was discussed. Informal gatherings of competitors before or after such meetings carry particular risk.

8.7 Competition law also applies to how we deal with customers and suppliers. Exclusive supply arrangements, loyalty rebates and long-term purchase commitments may be unlawful for a company with a strong position in a particular market. Seek advice from Legal and Compliance before agreeing any of these.

9. Gifts and Hospitality

9.1 Modest gifts and hospitality can help build good business relationships, but they must never influence, or appear to influence, a business decision. This section applies to gifts and hospitality you give on Meridian's behalf and to those you receive because of your work for Meridian. It should be read together with section 7.

9.2 Gifts and hospitality must always be:

- reasonable and proportionate in value and frequency;
- given or received openly, not in secret;
- not in cash or cash equivalents such as vouchers or gift cards;

- not offered or accepted during a tender, contract negotiation or supplier selection in which the other party is involved;
- permitted by the rules of the recipient's own organisation;
- properly recorded and, where they are an expense, claimed in line with the Travel and Expense Policy (POL-FIN-007).

9.3 Any gift or hospitality given or received with a value of more than £75 (£85, \$95 or RM 400) per person must be recorded in the Gifts and Hospitality Register using form F-140 within 5 working days of the gift or event. The register is maintained by Legal and Compliance and reviewed quarterly. Where the value is not known, record your best estimate. Gifts or hospitality from the same source that together exceed the threshold in any 12-month period must also be registered.

9.4 Any gift or hospitality with a value of more than £250 (£290, \$320 or RM 1,500) per person requires prior written approval from Legal and Compliance, requested by email to compliance@meridian-instruments.example, before it is offered or accepted. Approval must still be followed by a register entry on F-140. If you receive an unexpected gift above this value, report it to Legal and Compliance, who will decide whether it should be returned, donated to charity or kept by the company.

9.5 Travel and accommodation for customers or suppliers, for example for a factory acceptance test in Leeds or Penang, may be paid by Meridian only where there is a genuine business purpose, the itinerary does not include leisure side trips, and the arrangement has been approved in advance by Legal and Compliance. Per-diem cash allowances must never be paid to customer employees.

9.6 Stricter rules apply to public officials. You must not give any gift to a public official other than Meridian-branded promotional items of nominal value under £25, such as a pen, notebook or calendar. Any hospitality for a public official, whatever its value, including a working lunch, requires prior approval from the General Counsel. Meals provided during site visits by regulators, inspectors or auditors in the ordinary course of their work are limited to simple refreshments on site.

9.7 Never give or accept gifts or hospitality from anyone involved in a current or imminent procurement process, including tenders run under the Procurement Manual (POL-FIN-012). If you are a member of a tender evaluation panel, decline all hospitality from bidders until the contract has been awarded.

9.8 Personal gifts to colleagues, such as leaving or birthday collections, are not covered by this section.

10. Trade Compliance and Export Controls

10.1 Many of our products and technologies are subject to export control and sanctions laws in the UK, the EU, the United States and Malaysia. Breaching these laws can result in heavy fines, loss of export privileges and imprisonment of individuals.

10.2 Every product, component, software release and technical data package is classified by the Trade Compliance team before it can be exported. The Tessera TS-4 gateway contains an encryption module that is classified 5A992, which means that shipments to certain destinations and end-users require a licence or are prohibited. Atlas automatically blocks orders to embargoed destinations and screens every customer, consignee and end-user against restricted-party lists. You must never override or work around an Atlas trade compliance block. Questions about classification, licensing or screening results should be sent to trade compliance@meridian-instruments.example.

10.3 Exports include not only physical shipments but also the transfer of technical data or software by email, file sharing or download, and access to controlled technology by foreign nationals. Engineers in Forge and TesseraCloud Operations must check with Trade Compliance before sharing controlled source code or design documentation outside the company.

10.4 Be alert to red flags such as a customer who is reluctant to state the end use, an unusual delivery route, a request for modifications that do not fit the stated application, or payment by an unrelated third party. Stop the transaction and contact Trade Compliance.

10.5 We comply with sanctions regimes that restrict dealings with certain countries, entities and individuals. We do not participate in or comply with unsanctioned foreign boycotts.

10.6 Customs declarations must be accurate and complete. Declared values, tariff codes and countries of origin must be supported by records.

11. Protecting Information and Assets

11.1 Personal data. We respect the privacy of our colleagues, candidates, customers and suppliers. Personal data must be handled in line with the Data Protection Policy (POL-CORP-006). Suspected personal data breaches must be reported immediately through Beacon.

11.2 Confidential information. Information about our products, designs, pricing, customers, suppliers and finances is valuable. Share it only with people who need it for their work, and only with third parties who have signed a confidentiality agreement. Your obligation of confidentiality continues after your employment ends.

11.3 Information security. Follow the IT security rules set by the IT Security team under Mei-Ling Tan, including rules on passwords, multi-factor authentication, removable media and use of approved software. Report suspected phishing and security incidents through Beacon without delay.

11.4 Intellectual property. Inventions, designs, software and documents you create in the course of your employment belong to Meridian. Do not use third-party software, images, datasets or open-source code in our products without following the engineering approval process.

11.5 Company assets. Use Meridian's equipment, vehicles, funds and systems responsibly and for legitimate business purposes. Limited personal use of IT equipment is permitted where it does not interfere with your work or breach IT policy.

11.6 Accurate records. Financial records, test reports, calibration certificates, timesheets and expense claims must be complete, accurate and honest. Falsifying a record, including a calibration certificate or a Halcyon bump test log, is a serious breach of this Code.

11.7 Insider information. If you become aware of confidential information that could affect the share price of a listed customer, supplier or partner, you must not deal in their shares or pass the information on to anyone else.

11.8 Records must be kept for the periods set out in the Records Retention Schedule (POL-CORP-008) and must not be destroyed while they are subject to a legal hold issued by Legal and Compliance.

12. Accountability, Training and Administration

12.1 Responsibility for the Code. The Board has approved this Code and the Audit Committee oversees its implementation. The General Counsel is responsible for keeping the Code up to date, for interpreting it and for reporting to the Audit Committee on compliance.

12.2 Managers. Managers must make sure their teams have read and understood the Code, complete training on time and know how to raise concerns. Managers who receive a concern must pass it to Legal and Compliance or the Speak Up Officer.

12.3 Training. All new employees must complete Code of Conduct training within 30 days of joining. After that, every employee must complete the annual Code of Conduct refresher by 31 October each year. The refresher is assigned in Keel and covers this Code, anti-bribery, gifts and hospitality, competition law and speaking up. Legal and Compliance reports completion rates to ExCo monthly during the training window, and the company target is 98% completion by the deadline. Employees who have not completed the training by the deadline will be reminded by their manager, and persistent non-completion may be treated as a disciplinary matter. Employees in higher-risk roles, including Sales, Procurement and Trade Compliance, also complete role-specific modules.

12.4 Certification. As part of the annual refresher, every employee certifies that they have read the Code, that they have complied with it, and that they have reported any breaches of which they are aware.

12.5 Investigations. Suspected breaches will be investigated promptly, fairly and confidentially by people independent of the matter. Employees must cooperate fully with investigations and must not destroy or alter relevant documents.

12.6 Consequences. Breaches of the Code may result in disciplinary action up to and including dismissal, and may be reported to the relevant authorities. Managers who ignore or fail to report breaches may also face disciplinary action.

12.7 Waivers. Waivers of this Code for directors or members of ExCo may only be granted by the Board. Other waivers may only be granted by the General Counsel, in writing.

12.8 Review. This Code is reviewed at least every three years, or sooner if there are significant changes in law or in our business. The next scheduled review is in January 2028.

12.9 Related documents.

Code | Title

HBK-HR-001 | Employee Handbook
POL-CORP-004 | Speak Up (Whistleblowing) Policy
POL-CORP-006 | Data Protection Policy
POL-CORP-008 | Records Retention Schedule
POL-FIN-007 | Travel and Expense Policy
POL-FIN-012 | Procurement Manual
POL-HR-040 | Disciplinary and Grievance Procedure
POL-HR-052 | Recruitment and Selection Manual
F-140 | Gifts and Hospitality Register entry
F-150 | Conflict of Interest Declaration

12.10 Questions about this Code should be sent to compliance@meridian-instruments.example.